to the nitty-gritty of life and to think that they would be leaving soon for Egypt.

I talked to him about that in among the four-day glut of conversation in which we all wallowed delightedly. Drawing from my experience at the Navy Yard, I drew a dark picture of what he would find civil service to be. As a matter of fact, I made it rather worse than it was because I hoped he would change his mind. He didn't; he was determined to go.

Over the years, I discovered that Bill was a disappointed man. He had been an undergraduate at Harvard, and he longed to be on the Harvard faculty. His best friends (Whipple, for instance) were on the Harvard faculty and he held to them tightly as though he hoped this would make him one, too, vicariously.

Although he was world famous as a blood immunochemist, it bothered him to be at Boston University. During the war, he had switched to Harvard to work on some blood-fractionation project but had not gotten along with the head of that project (an overbearing tyrant, from all accounts), and Bill had had to come back to Boston University, something he apparently considered a defeat.

Now he was leaving again in search of greatness, and nothing I said was going to keep him home.

8

The movers picked up our furniture in Stuyvesant Town on July 20 and it was good-bye to Manhattan, exactly one year after we had

signed the lease and become Manhattanites. We moved the furniture into the Somerville apartment on July 22, and four days later we celebrated our seventh wedding anniversary.

But if it was off with the old, it was also on with the new. On July 27, I met Harry Stubbs for the first time. He wrote science fiction under the name of Hal Clement, and then and ever has proved a wonderful person—quiet and kind. I've never known him to lose his temper or to say an ungentle word.

On July 29, we left the sublet after a two-month stay and completed our eighth move. It cost us just $100. Naturally, it was once again a super heat wave, with temperatures topping 95 day after day.

But then, at least we had a telephone installed at once—our third. From that